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CITY OF SANTEE
CITY ATTORNEY'S IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE "Y"
1% GENERAL TRANSACTIONS AND USE (SALES) TAX
FOR TEN (10) YEARS

On June 24, 2026, the City Council voted to place Measure "Y" on the November 3, 2026 General Municipal Election ballot.

If approved by a majority of Santee voters, this Measure would authorize a one percent (1%) retail transactions and use (sales) tax within the City of Santee. It is estimated that Measure "Y" will provide an additional $14,000,000 in annual local funding for ten (10) years that could be used for City of Santee services and infrastructure, including repairing streets and potholes; cleaning and maintaining streets, sidewalks, parks and public facilities, repairing and replacing stormdrains, local traffic management, fire protection, paramedic, crime prevention, and 911 emergency response. This tax would be a "general tax," meaning that revenues raised from the tax would go into the City's general fund to pay for any lawful City program, improvement, or service.

The California Constitution (Proposition 218) and Revenue and Taxation Code section 7285.9 authorize the City to levy a general transactions and use/sales tax at a rate of one percent (1%) so long as the tax is approved by a majority of the voters voting in an election on that issue. If approved, the tax would become operative on April 1, 2027 and remain in effect for ten (10) years until it expires on March 31, 2037. Any extension of this tax beyond that date would require majority voter approval at a future City election.

Measure "Y" establishes a five (5) member Citizens' Oversight Committee consisting of Santee residents, property owners and business owners appointed by the City Council. The Committee shall hold meetings open to the public pursuant to the California Brown Act. Each year, City staff shall present a proposed annual spending plan to the Committee, identifying City improvements, projects, programs, services proposed to be funded with Measure "Y" revenues. The Committee may make recommendations about the spending plan, which shall be incorporated into the City Manager's proposed annual budget and subject to City Council approval.

The Committee shall also be authorized to independently review the City's annual financial audit identifying Measure "Y" revenues collected and the expenditures made from such revenues in the prior year. The Committee shall report their findings publicly, including any concerns over use of Measure "Y" revenues, through an annual report presented to the City Council at a public meeting.

The tax would be paid in addition to current sales taxes and would be collected at the same time and in the same manner as existing sales taxes. All revenues raised by the tax would remain in the City and would not be shared with the State, County or any other agency.

A "yes" vote on Measure "Y" will authorize the 1% transactions and use (sales) tax for 10 years.

A "no" vote on Measure "Y" will not authorize the 1% transactions and use (sales) tax for 10 years.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure "Y". If you desire a copy of the Measure, please call the City Clerk's Office at (619) 258-4100 or email at clerk@cityofsanteeca.gov and a copy will be sent at no cost to you.

/s/ SHAWN HAGERTY
City Attorney